

sation, all the key TV companies have launched their 3D models in India. LG, Samsung, Panasonic and Sony are the main players in this space.

Samsung has around ten 3D models, and is the first company to indigenously assemble 3D televisions at its facilities in Noida and Chennai. These ultra-slim models include LCD, LED and plasma platforms. Samsung TVs offer automatic 2D-to-3D conversion, as well as Wi-Fi capability to connect to media on the Internet.

Sony India is focusing on the BRAVIA LED-backlit LCD television, which, according to Kimura, offers very high contrast levels and vibrant colours. Sony also offers Wi-Fi, in addition to widgets that enable easy connection to 3D content on the Web.

Panasonic and LG too have LCD, LED and plasma 3D televisions as part of their Viera and Infinia ranges, respectively.

Almost all the brands in question have full HD 1080p models, offering

very high resolutions and contrast ratios. 3D televisions should typically have a refresh rate of 200-240 Hz to avoid ghosting or cross-talk (the ghostly lines which appear around images when they move swiftly). The 3D glasses bundled should also be of good quality, and apart from a good 3D experience, they should be able to cut out the peripheral environment in order to immerse the user.

LED-backlit, plain LCD, as well as plasma models are available at varying price ranges. Which one wins your heart depends on what you need. Plasma TVs have a faster refresh rate, wider viewing angles, better colour fidelity and improved black levels, and are relatively free of motion blur and ghosting. LCD and LED-backlit televisions, on the other hand, have a higher brightness. Plus, LCD technology has improved vastly, and many of the recent models perform comparably with plasma models.

Of course, price would also be an

important consideration. You could get LCD models for around ₹ 150,000, plasma models for around ₹ 300,000, and LED-backlit models at price points ranging from ₹ 150,000 to 400,000 or even higher. Last September, Samsung initiated a price war in the US market, to an extent that caused other brands to recalibrate their marketing goals.

We could safely say that the technology has come to the Indian markets. However, the situation is sure to be a bit shaky until content becomes more widespread. In India, we cannot rely on the Internet or disk-based content alone, and would require some regular channels to come up if 3D is to overtake its 2D incumbents.

The sellers, however, are optimistic. "The Indian consumer is willing to experiment and hence we have high hopes from this technology," says Kimura. ●

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